

Now let's write a new program that greets a user whose name has already been stored:

```
greet_user.py  from pathlib import Path
                import json

                ❶ path = Path('username.json')
                  contents = path.read_text()
                ❷ username = json.loads(contents)

                print(f"Welcome back, {username}!")
```

We read the contents of the data file ❶ and then use `json.loads()` to assign the recovered data to the variable `username` ❷. Since we've recovered the username, we can welcome the user back with a personalized greeting:

Welcome back, Eric!

We need to combine these two programs into one file. When someone runs *remember_me.py*, we want to retrieve their username from memory if possible; if not, we'll prompt for a username and store it in *username.json* for next time. We could write a try-except block here to respond appropriately if *username.json* doesn't exist, but instead we'll use a handy method from the `pathlib` module:

```
remember      from pathlib import Path
_me.py        import json

                path = Path('username.json')
                ❶ if path.exists():
                    contents = path.read_text()
                    username = json.loads(contents)
                    print(f"Welcome back, {username}!")
                ❷ else:
                    username = input("What is your name? ")
                    contents = json.dumps(username)
                    path.write_text(contents)
                    print(f"We'll remember you when you come back, {username}!")
```

There are many helpful methods you can use with `Path` objects. The `exists()` method returns `True` if a file or folder exists and `False` if it doesn't. Here we use `path.exists()` to find out if a username has already been stored ❶. If *username.json* exists, we load the username and print a personalized greeting to the user.

If the file *username.json* doesn't exist ❷, we prompt for a username and store the value that the user enters. We also print the familiar message that we'll remember them when they come back.

Whichever block executes, the result is a username and an appropriate greeting. If this is the first time the program runs, this is the output:

What is your name? **Eric**
We'll remember you when you come back, Eric!
